

Tools of the Trade

The PM's vocabulary expands

STATUS REPORT

Month 2 Status Report — XR Platform

Pulse Works × Kurosawa Digital — Prepared by Hina · Reviewed by Ren

Overall Status

Area	Status	Notes
Scope	GREEN	No unapproved changes since scope baseline approval
Schedule	AMBER	2.5-day variance on environment setup; recovery plan active
Cost	GREEN	Actual spend 4% below cost baseline ; contingency reserve untouched
Resources	AMBER	Tetsu at 115% utilization; cross-training in progress

Key Accomplishments

- Spatial mapping module passed initial **work authorization** and development began
- Post-crash retrospective completed; 4 action items tracked
- First cross-training session held (Hina shadowing Tetsu on environment configuration)

Performance Measurement

Planned value through Month 2: ¥9.6M. **Earned value**: ¥8.9M. **Actual cost**: ¥8.5M. Schedule is slightly behind plan, but cost efficiency is favorable. The **control account** for the rendering module shows the largest variance — directly tied to the environment crash recovery.

Upcoming Decisions

- AR module scope decision required from Director Kudo by Friday
- Vendor selection for gesture recognition library — evaluation in progress

Hina (陽菜) "Ren, is Saki always that intense? She sent twelve comments on the draft." **Ren (蓮)** "Yes." A pause. "But she's really good at her job."

Hina raises an eyebrow but says nothing.

Baseline

DEFINITION An approved reference point used for comparison against actual results.

COMPONENTS Scope baseline (WBS + scope statement); schedule baseline (approved timeline); cost baseline (time-phased budget).

RELATED scope baseline, cost baseline, planned value

EXAMPLE The status report compares actual progress against the approved baselines — scope is on track, schedule shows a 2.5-day variance, cost is 4% favorable.

Variance

DEFINITION The difference between planned and actual performance.

COMPONENTS Schedule variance (timing gaps); cost variance (budget gaps); scope variance (deliverable gaps); trend direction.

RELATED baseline, cost variance, earned value

EXAMPLE The 2.5-day schedule variance on environment setup is a measurable gap between where the plan said the team would be and where they actually are.

Performance Measurement

DEFINITION The process of tracking and evaluating project progress.

COMPONENTS Defining metrics; collecting data; comparing against baselines; reporting results; recommending corrective actions.

RELATED earned value, planned value, actual cost

EXAMPLE Hina's report tracks planned value (¥9.6M), earned value (¥8.9M), and actual cost (¥8.5M) — three data points that together reveal both schedule lag and cost efficiency.

Control Account

DEFINITION A management control point for scope, schedule, and cost integration.

COMPONENTS Assigned to a WBS element; has its own budget and schedule; owned by one person; performance measured independently.

RELATED WBS, work package, cost baseline

EXAMPLE The rendering module has its own control account, making it easy to see that the crash recovery is the source of the schedule variance — without that isolation, the problem would be hidden in aggregate numbers.

Work Authorization

DEFINITION A formal approval to begin work on a specific project activity.

COMPONENTS Identifies the activity or work package; specifies start conditions; assigns resources; links to the schedule and budget.

RELATED work package, scope baseline, schedule

EXAMPLE The spatial mapping module received formal work authorization before development began — ensuring the team had approved scope, budget, and schedule before committing resources.